

B01 Quick Revision

Engineering SQL contracts before the closed-book check

Eight ideas to retrieve without the teaching book

L01 Grain/cardinality

Declare each input grain, predict match cardinality, decide output grain before joining. Never use DISTINCT as unexplained fan-out repair.

L02 Staged SQL

Name stages by purpose; declare each stage grain; run the first suspect stage independently when a control breaks.

L03 Windows

Window functions preserve rows. Make ordering/tie rules deterministic; distinguish previous observed row from previous calendar period.

L04 Rules/time

Write numerator, denominator, included statuses and [start,end) time boundaries before SQL.

L05 Quality

A diagnostic query represents a business rule. Distinguish legitimate child rows from duplicate business events; classify BLOCK/WARN with impact.

L06 Reconciliation

Controls should be able to disagree with the transformation. Check rows, keys, money and boundaries through an independent path.

L07 EXPLAIN

A plan is evidence, not a speed claim. Read scan/join shape and estimates; an index proposal is a hypothesis until measured.

L08 Handoff

Readable stages, deterministic output order, grain comments, controls, limitation, owner and safe rerun note make SQL maintainable.

Before the mastery check

Close this revision. From memory, explain one fan-out failure, one independent reconciliation, one deterministic window rule, one half-open interval, and why EXPLAIN does not prove a speedup.